

ERWC with Integrated ELD

“On Leaving | On Staying Behind”

Developed by Jennifer Fletcher

STUDENT VERSION

Module Texts

Fletcher, Jennifer. “Interview with Diana Garcia.” 17 July 2017.

Garcia, Diana. “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” *Prairie Schooner*, vol. 88, no. 4, 2014, pp. 11-13.

Garcia, Diana. Audio Recording of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” 6 June 2018.

Reading Rhetorically

Text 1 – Garcia, “On Leaving On Staying Behind”
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Preparing to Read

Activity 1: Getting Ready to Read – Quickwrite

Prompt: Describe your best qualities or assets.

- What personal strengths and resources do you rely on to help you deal with difficult situations?
- How do you prepare to face challenges?
- What strategies do you use to promote your success?

Activity 2: Exploring Key Concepts – Exigence Concept Map

This activity, adapted from *Words, Words, Words* (1999) by Janet Allen, will help you explore the rhetorical concept of **exigence**, or a need or problem that can be addressed through rhetoric. The word exigence also has meaning outside of rhetoric studies. First, read the definitions of exigence from the Oxford English Dictionary (OED). Then use the model that follows to deepen your understanding of the way an exigence can motivate people to write, speak, or act in various situations.

For the section on your definition, you may synthesize and paraphrase the OED definitions of exigence in a way that make sense to you.

For the section on your personal examples, list problems or needs that motivate you to take rhetorical action. For your non-examples, list things that you do not consider to be urgent and important.

Definitions of Exigence from the OED (accessed February 24, 2018):

1. What is needed or required; a thing wanted or demanded; a requirement, a necessity.
2. A state of urgent need; a situation of trouble or difficulty; an extremity; (in pl.) straits.
3. Urgent need or demand; necessity; emergency; great trouble or difficulty.

Concept Map	
Concept:	My Definition:
Synonyms:	My Sentence:
My Personal Examples:	My Non-Examples

As you read “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” think about the exigencies motivating the poet to write and her characters to act.

Activity 3: Surveying the Text

What are your thoughts when you read the titles? In what kinds of situations might some people leave while others stay behind? What do you notice about the form of Garcia’s writing? How is the experience of reading a poem different from reading a short story or novel?

Activity 4: Understanding Key Vocabulary

The following list of words and phrases from the poems have been defined for you. It will be helpful to know these definitions as you read the poems. Use an online dictionary if you would like to hear how these words are pronounced.

1. coyotes: smugglers
2. mis primas: my cousins (female)
3. la migra: Border Patrol
4. una profe de los estados unidos: a professor from the United States
5. serape: cloak or wrap; bedding
6. endurance: stamina or forbearance
7. persists: continues or lasts
8. fleet: fast or speedy

Activity 5: Creating Personal Learning Goals

Diana Garcia explains in an interview that one of her reasons for writing “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” was to “imagine survival strategies for young women who travel alone in search of a better life” (July 17, 2017). The ability to imagine and bring about our own success is key not only to surviving but also to thriving.

This activity asks you to imagine—and then pursue—learning goals that will help you grow as a thinker and communicator. As you set your goals, you might want to consider the two assignments you will be completing for this module: a short literary analysis and a creative response of your choice. Both assignments require you to read critically and communicate effectively. Consider the following questions:

- What strengths do I have as a reader and writer that I can build on?
- What do I want to learn how to do or do better?
- What do I need to keep me moving forward in my intellectual growth?

Choose two or three goals that are important to you and record these in your notes. Focus on imagining and creating your success as you engage the learning experiences in this module.

Reading Purposefully

Activity 6: Reading for Understanding – Pairs Conversation

After reading and listening to the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” discuss the questions that follow with a partner.

- What are these poems about? What’s the time, place, and occasion?
- What’s the daughter’s situation? What’s the mother’s situation?
- What ideas or images stand out to you?

Activity 7: Reading for Understanding – Interrupted Reading

For this activity, you will be participating in an interrupted reading of the poem “On Leaving.” This kind of slow reading helps you gain a deeper understanding of a text. Your teacher will show you only two lines from the poem at a time. After reading the lines, discuss what you notice as a class. Consider Garcia’s word choice (including word connotations), sentence structure, imagery, and anything else that seems important. Annotate your copy of the poem as you discuss the lines.

Activity 8: Annotating and Questioning the Text

Now continue annotating and questioning both poems on your own. Write your annotations on your copies of the poems before responding to the questions below.

1. What does the daughter mean when she says, “I have tested myself against her speed, my younger cousins’ endurance”? What does this show about her character?
2. Who are the other characters in these poems? What do they help us understand about the situations the mother and daughter are facing?
3. What is the significance of the different colored bandanas? What does this detail help us understand about the daughter’s situation? About the larger context for the poems?

Questioning the Text

Activity 9: Thinking Critically – Dialogic Three-Chart

The paired poems speak to each other in important ways. Sometimes the connection is direct, as when both the daughter and the mother speaks about the daughter’s ability to run fast. At other times the connection is indirect, as when the mother and daughter describe the different challenges they face.

For this activity, you will be matching lines from the two poems that seem to relate to each other in important ways and then synthesizing these lines to make an interpretive claim about the meaning of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” Think about how the two poems—and the two perspectives—work together to create a cohesive whole. What do both voices contribute to our understanding of the experience of emigration?

Write your matching quotations from the poems in the first two columns of the Three-Chart. In the third column, “Combined Significance,” write your interpretative claims about how the two quotations from the individual poems contribute to the meaning of the work as a whole.

An example has been done for you.

	Lines from “On Leaving”	Lines from “On Staying Behind”	Combined Significance
1	“I know now how fast I can run.”	“She thinks I don’t know why she runs.”	Both the daughter and mother understand the dangers of the journey, as well as the daughter’s ability to deal with those dangers. These lines also show the women’s reluctance to talk openly about their worst fears. The journey and the separation must be handled with courage and self-discipline.
2			
3			
4			
5			

Reading Purposefully

Activity 10: Negotiating Meaning – Structured Discussion

In your group, number yourselves 1-4. Each person will have a specific role during the discussion (see the discussion questions that follow).

Step One: Students 1 and 2 will begin the discussion while students 3 and 4 take notes in a T-chart. The T-chart will be a record of the main points and examples discussed by Students 1 and 2. Students 1 and 2 will have five minutes for their dialogue.

Student 1	Student 2

Step Two: Student 3 now summarizes the discussion and then asks for elaboration or clarification on one underdeveloped but important point AND joins the conversation while 4 continues to take notes in a three-chart (see the example below). Students 1, 2, and 3 will have seven more minutes to continue the discussion. Try using the sentence starters that follow to help each other elaborate upon and clarify your ideas:

- Can you elaborate on this...?
- What do you mean by...?
- Can you tell me more about...?
- What makes you think that?
- Can you clarify the part about...?
- Can you be more specific?
- How so?
- How/why is that important? (Zwiers and Crawford 32).

Student 4 records key points and examples in the three-chart.

Student 1	Student 2	Student 3

Step Three: Student 4 now gives credit to individuals for significant ideas and synthesizes work of the group into a short statement. Groups may have five minutes for this final step.

Discussion Questions:

Self-efficacy is a concept in education that means “faith in your own effort and effectiveness.” A person with a strong sense of self-efficacy trusts that he or she will be able to figure out how to be successful under a variety of difficult circumstances.

- How much faith do you think the daughter has in her own strength? To what extent do you think she trusts her own ability to find a way to survive? How do you know? What do other characters say? Is there any textual evidence that contradicts this view?
- How is self-efficacy different from motivation or determination?
- How important do you think it is for people to have confidence in their own assets and strengths? Who are people you know with a strong sense of self-efficacy? To what extent does this sense of self-efficacy help them succeed?

Activity 11: Examining the Structure of the Text – Descriptive Outline of “On Staying Behind”

Take a few minutes to notice the structure of the two poems. How many lines does each poem have? What is the effect of this? Do the lines rhyme? Are there other similarities between the structure of the paired poems? Discuss your observations with a partner.

As an exercise in understanding the poem’s internal structure, divide “On Staying Behind” (the poem told from the mother’s perspective) into separate stanzas. What do you see as the functional sections of the poem? Where are the shifts? Where do you see the poem change its focus? Draw lines across the page separating the poem into different chunks.

Now use your descriptive outlining skills to note what each section is saying and doing. Write your “says” statements in the right margin of the poem and your “does” statements in the left margin.

Example for “On Leaving.”

“On Leaving”		
Does: Shows the daughter has a lot of strength, endurance, and responsibility. She’s willing to persevere.	I can run five times around the village, my dog beside me. I have tested myself against her speed, my younger cousins’ endurance. I win. My cousins go with me this morning, their dark hair glossy, so young their shoulders. Their mothers tell me to watch over them.	Says: She can run faster than others. Her aunts expect her to take care of her younger cousins.
Does: Shows that she’s doing this for her family; she’s connected to her village; also shows her love for her mother and how the people who stay behind are either old or have money.	I have said goodbye to all who remain, grayed village elders, wooden statues of saints in our small church, my mother. I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest of the girl cousins, no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here. I wear only what I have. I carry a blouse one aunt gave me, a friend’s old sandals for days when heat persists into the night.	Says: She has said her goodbyes and is prepared to leave.

Does: Reveals that she's not the first to go and conveys the mortal dangers of the situation.

My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early in the morning and at night. When you reach the trains, gain a space in the middle; don't move. Don't let anyone steal your space. When we reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing yellow bandanas, not red or green. Those wearing yellow come from our region, they speak our language, they are known to our village.

If no one waits at the border wearing yellow, we wait or take our chances. I have waited two years for this chance. No more.

Says: Her relatives who have already left have given her advice for the journey. She's already been waiting two years to leave.

Does:
Demonstrates her determination, maturity, and confidence. Shows she makes decisions for herself and is more knowledge-able than her older cousins assume. Offers alternatives to rape and murder.

If the coyotes separate me from my two cousins, mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life.

They think I don't know what they mean. I know what a man can take from a woman. I know my younger cousins' pride.

I will protect them from their pride, our family honor. I will scream or fight if I can. I will run if I can. I know now how fast I can run.

Says: Her cousins who have made the journey have advised her to cooperate with the smugglers. She knows there's a risk of sexual assault. She also knows her younger male cousins would want to protect her and that if they fight the smugglers, they could get killed. She plans to protect herself and her cousins.

Activity 13: Examining the Structure of the Text – Quickwrite or Pairs Conversation

What do you notice about the structure of the poems? What is Garcia trying to accomplish in each section? Why do you think the poems are not divided into stanzas?

Activity 14: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Kairos Connection

Kairos is a Greek word meaning “the opportune moment” or “situational time.” We can think of kairos as the immediate social situation in which acts of communication must take place. Exploring the kairos of a rhetorical situation can thus be a way to grapple with an ongoing conversation (one indeed that may have been ongoing for decades or centuries) while also examining how the conversation has changed—and continues to change—in response to recent events.

Questions to guide this thinking could include the following:

- To what extent are these issues relevant today?
- What opportunities do writers have for addressing these issues today?
- To what extent has the conversation on immigration changed since Garcia first published these poems?
- How far back does this issue go? Do you see this text as participating in an ongoing conversation? Why or why not?
- What’s changed—culturally, socially, or politically—since the text was first published?
- Would older generations have viewed this issue differently from how your generation tends to see it?

Activity 15: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – The Effects of Adjectives

Step One: Put away your copies of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” so that you no longer have these in front of you. Then, without looking back at the poems, add your own adjectives to the poems in all the places where Garcia’s adjectives have been removed. Think about what these adjectives add to our understanding of the poems’ setting, characters, and themes. You’ll notice that some words that function as adjectives have also been omitted.

“On Leaving”

I can run _____ times around the village, my dog beside me. I have tested myself against her speed, my _____ cousins’ endurance. I win. My cousins go with me this morning, their _____ hair _____, so _____ their shoulders. Their mothers tell me to watch over them. I have said goodbye to all who remain, _____ village elders, _____ statues of saints in our _____ church, my mother. I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest of the girl cousins, no _____ beauty, no wealth to keep me here. I wear only what I have. I carry a blouse one aunt gave me, a friend’s _____ sandals for days when heat persists into the night. My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early in the morning and at night. When you reach the trains, gain a space in the middle; don’t move. Don’t let anyone steal your space. When we reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing _____ bandanas, not _____ or _____. Those wearing _____ come from our region, they speak our language, they are known to our village. If no one waits at the border wearing _____, we wait or take our chances. I have waited _____ years for this chance. No more. If the coyotes separate me from my two cousins, mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life. They think I don’t know what they mean. I know what a man can take from a woman. I know my _____ cousins’ pride. I will protect them from their pride, our _____ honor. I will scream or fight if I can. I will run if I can. I know now how fast I can run.

“On Staying Behind”

She thinks I don't know why she runs. Not to catch the trains
or escape la migra or outrun packs of _____ dogs. I listened
to the advice her cousins sent, the older girl cousins, married,
_____ girls who left our village with their husbands.
The journey is harsh, more than _____ weeks if she's lucky.
So many dangers, only _____ cousins to protect her.
My daughter has no husband. She cannot stay with me. I will
not have her stay with me to starve. She leaves with no wealth.
She and her cousins are their own wealth. I see the strength
in their arms and shoulders, blood that pumps through heart and lungs.
No water, no beans or corn. Today, the woman studying our village,
una profe de los estados unidos, spilled our pot of beans.
This woman has never known hunger. I saw her shock when I sifted
beans from dirt, placed beans, dirt, the bit of water I had planned to use
for grinding the _____ corn. What is a _____ dirt, I thought, the _____ dirt
in which I grew these beans? A child should not see a mother starve to death.
A mother should not hear that her last daughter has disappeared.
I bless this _____ child, daughter of my heart, the one I hoped
would wrap my body in a serape and lay me next to her father
at the edge of the church yard. I bless her journey, wishing
her _____ passage, _____ journey. I have said my prayers
to the _____ saints. I have eaten my _____ meal. I will lay
myself alongside her dog tonight. Perhaps tomorrow, more food
will come my way. Again, I stay behind. I will wait and hope.

Step Two: Now look back at “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” and compare your choice of adjectives to Garcia’s choices. What do you notice? How do Garcia’s adjectives affect the reader’s understanding of the poems’ setting, characters, and themes? Discuss your observations and insights in a four-minute quickwrite.

Activity 16: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Say, Mean, Matter, Do

In Say, Mean, Matter, Do, you will cite, interpret, and analyze direct quotations from the paired poems. Each column addresses a different question about the text:

1. What does it say?
2. What does it mean?
3. Why does it matter?
4. What does it do?

The “Say” and “Mean” columns give you an opportunity to practice selecting and paraphrasing or explaining direct quotations. The “Matter” and “Do” columns give you an opportunity to practice your critical thinking skills. For the final column, use your rhetorical knowledge to analyze the effect and function of the poet’s words. What is the quotation doing rhetorically? How does it affect you as a reader?

See the directions and example that follow:

Say (direct quotation)	Mean (paraphrase or explanation)	Matter (significance and connection to theme)	Do (rhetorical effect or function)
“I saw her shock when I sifted/beans from dirt, placed beans, dirt, the bit of water I had planned to use/ for grinding the last dried corn” (Garcia).	The lady from the U.S. accidentally dropped a pot of beans. Since the mother is living in poverty, she cannot buy more beans. So she went through the dirt to put the dropped beans to use.	This shows the harsh reality of the conditions that the mother and daughter are living in and explains why people might leave their homeland despite all the risks.	Shocks the reader and gives us the truth of how sad their conditions are. Makes us feel sorrow and pity for the characters.

Questioning the Text

Activity 17: Summarizing and Responding

Respond to the following questions in your notes after discussing your ideas with a partner or small group.

- How would you describe the daughter's character?
- How would you describe the mother's character?
- What are the poems saying about the experiences of leaving and staying behind? What challenges and resources are present in each situation? Is one situation more difficult than the other?
- What do the mother and daughter understand about each other? Are there things they don't understand about each other?
- What things might be difficult for mothers and daughters in this situation to talk about? Why?

Activity 18: Thinking Critically – Brief Literary Analysis

In an analysis, we examine the relations between parts and whole to see how something works. Write a one-page literary analysis of the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” in which you discuss how the poet creates meaning. Consider the effects and functions of Garcia's choices. What is she saying and doing? And **how** is she saying and doing these things? Support your interpretive claims with evidence from the poems.

Prepare to write your analysis by closely reading and annotating the poems, noting the poet's choices about such things as diction, syntax, imagery, tone, figurative language, and any other features of the text you think are important.

Activity 19: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – (Part 1) Bring a Text to Class (Homework)

Find a recently published source (e.g., newspaper article, scholarly article, blog, photo essay, podcast, etc.) that demonstrates the extent to which the issues Garcia addresses in her poems are timely and important today. Bring this text to class and be prepared to summarize it and explain why you chose it.

This is your opportunity to find and share current texts that add to the conversation.

Text 2 – Fletcher, “Interview with Diana Garcia”

Reading Purposefully

Activity 20: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Interview with Diana Garcia

Read the interview with Diana Garcia. Then respond to the following questions in a five-minute quickwrite:

- What other issues and contexts does the interview introduce?
- What does Garcia identify as her purpose for writing the poems?
- What exigencies is Garcia responding to?
- What does this broader context contribute to your understanding of the poems’ themes?

As you search for an additional source, consider how Garcia’s contexts and purpose relate to ongoing conversations on transnational migrations.

Questioning the Text

Activity 21: Reflecting on Your Reading Process – Pairs Conversation and Evidence Chart

Turn and talk to a partner about how you feel you're doing with the reading activities so far. What challenges, if any, have you encountered? What have you done to address those challenges?

Now complete the following chart by recording evidence and examples of the reading skills you have been further developing during this module.

I am able to...	Evidence and Examples
Paraphrase the words of other writers	
Consider different perspectives in a rhetorical situation	
Analyze diction, syntax, and imagery	
Analyze tone	
Annotate and question texts	
Make inferences about a text (i.e., understand what is implied but not directly stated)	

Preparing to Respond

Discovering What You Think

Activity 22: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Creative Response

Consider the topics raised by Garcia in her poems. In what ways are any of them issues in your own life or community? Which of those issues calls urgently for a response now?

Choose one of the following forms of writing to express your ideas:

1. A set of paired poems that explore the topic from different perspectives
2. A profile feature article
3. A work of creative nonfiction (e.g., a memoir or reflective essay)

Your finished piece of writing should be between 650 and 1,000 words in length (lengths will vary according to form). Develop your ideas through focused inquiry, including background research and interviews as needed. Include a Works Cited list for any citations.

Before choosing your genre, consider the kinds of stories that can be told through poetry, feature articles, and creative nonfiction. Whose story do you want to tell? What need or problem do you want to address? What do you want to do about that need or problem? What's the best way to do this? Select your genre based on your purpose and interests.

A successful response to the task will do all of the following:

- Demonstrate an ability to understand a perspective on its own terms
- Establish the timeliness and importance of the issue
- Engage multiple points of view
- Draw on research into relevant contexts and experiences
- Make strategic use of language choices to create particular meanings and effects
- Make strategic use of organizational choices to develop and support ideas

Rubric Scores:

6 – Exceptional

5 – Commendable

4 – Adequate

3 – Limited

2 – Inadequate

1 – Failing

0 – Off-topic or plagiarized

Reading Rhetorically

Questioning the Text

Activity 23: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – (Part II) Preparation for Structured Discussion

To prepare to respond to the rhetorical situation, you will share the outside source you found that relates to the issues and contexts addressed by the poems. Share this source with a small group, summarizing its key points for your peers and explaining the ways it relates to Garcia’s poems. Compare and contrast the different sources you’ve collected as a group. What do the perspectives, issues, and information addressed in your sources add to your understanding of the context for Garcia’s work?

Take note of the titles of the texts your group members share. You may want to use these as sources of inspiration or information for your culminating writing task. Be sure to notice if any of the outside sources are profile feature articles, or articles that offer a focused description of the experience(s) of a single person or group.

Activity 24: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Bring a Text to Class Structured Discussion

In your group, number yourselves 1-4. Each person will have a specific role during the discussion (see the discussion questions that follow).

Step One: Students 1 and 2 will begin the discussion while students 3 and 4 take notes in a T-chart. The T-chart will be a record of the main points and examples discussed by Students 1 and 2. Students 1 and 2 will have five minutes for their dialogue.

Student 1	Student 2

Step Two: Student 3 now summarizes the discussion and then asks for elaboration or clarification on one underdeveloped but important point AND joins the conversation while 4 continues to take notes in a three-chart (see the example below). Students 1, 2, and 3 will have seven more minutes to continue the discussion. Try using the sentence starters that follow to help each other elaborate upon and clarify your ideas:

- Can you elaborate on this...?
- What do you mean by...?
- Can you tell me more about...?
- What makes you think that?
- Can you clarify the part about...?
- Can you be more specific?
- How so?
- How/why is that important? (Zwiers and Crawford 32)

Student 4 records key points and examples in the three-chart.

Student 1	Student 2	Student 3

Step Three: Student 4 now gives credit to individuals for significant ideas and synthesizes work of the group into a short statement. Groups may have five minutes for this final step.

First, review the definitions of exigence that follow from the Oxford English Dictionary:

Definitions of exigence from the OED (accessed February 24, 2018):

1. What is needed or required; a thing wanted or demanded; a requirement, a necessity.
2. A state of urgent need; a situation of trouble or difficulty; an extremity; (in pl.) straits.
3. Urgent need or demand; necessity; emergency; great trouble or difficulty.

Questions for Structured Discussion:

- What exigencies do the mother and daughter face in the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind”? What makes these exigencies particularly urgent and difficult? How do you know?
- What problems or needs were addressed in the outside sources your group members brought to class? How do you feel about the situations you read about or heard about?
- Is there a specific story or person from the sources that stood out? If so, why?
- What particular needs or demands do you see as most important to address? Why? What is required to address these needs or demands?

Writing Rhetorically

Revising Rhetorically

Activity 25: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Gathering Evidence

The kind of inquiry work you will need to do depends upon the genre and topic you selected. For instance, if you have chosen to write a profile feature article (a newspaper or magazine article focusing on a single person or group), you may need to conduct interviews and background research. You may also want to consult resources that offer advice for writing in the genre you have selected. The *New York Times* offers a guide to writing profile feature articles: movies2.nytimes.com/learning/students/writing/voices.html.

Keep in mind that you have already collected evidence and generated ideas through your quickwrites, notes, and annotations. You can also use your personal experience and observations as relevant. Consider the following sources of information:

- What personal experiences can you draw on in developing your response?
- What expertise do you have that can help you contribute to the conversation?
- What connections can you make to your own background and identity?

Organize your notes and readings as needed and work to develop your ideas.

Composing a Draft

Activity 26: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting

Write a partial rough draft of your poem, article, or short work of creative nonfiction. If you get stuck while drafting, try setting a timer for five minutes and forcing yourself to keep writing—without judgment—until the timer goes off. Continue writing idea chunks until your composition starts to take shape.

Activity 27: Making Choices About Learning Goals

Take a moment to consider your growth as a writer. What goals do you have for yourself? Briefly respond to each question that follows in your notes.

- Where am I going? (Describe your task.)
- How am I going? (Describe your progress and process.)
- What do I need to get there? (Set learning goals for yourself.)

Activity 28: Making Choices as You Write – Genre Awareness and Analysis

For this assignment, you have your choice of writing in one of three forms of creative expression: Poetry, a profile feature article, or creative nonfiction (including memoir writing). Consider the narrative strategies and elements of literary craft that are most appropriate to the genre and subject you've selected. Be sure to review your work analyzing the rhetorical effects of adjectives. Consider, too, the use of signal words or transitions.

Take a look at what you've drafted so far.

Now turn and talk to a partner about the genre you're writing in. Why did you choose this genre? What can this genre do? What kinds of stories can be told through this genre? Are there additional features of this genre that you haven't used yet (e.g., dialogue, imagery, figurative language, plot events) that you might like to try out?

Revising Rhetorically

Activity 29: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically – Purpose Analysis

Complete the Purpose Analysis of your draft using the graphic organizer below.

WRITER'S CLAIM/POSITION What does the writer say?		
Purpose		
IDEAS Describe what the writer wants the audience to know or understand.	FEELINGS Describe the emotions the writer wants the audience to feel.	ACTIONS Describe what the writer wants the audience to do.
PAST, PRESENT, OR FUTURE Explain whether the writer wants the audience to make a judgment about the past, understand a statement about the present, or decide a course of action for the future.		
Quickwrite How would you describe the purpose of this text? What do you think the writer hopes to accomplish through his or her argument? Does the argument serve multiple purposes? If so, which one(s) is/are most important?		

Fletcher, Jennifer. *Teaching Arguments: Rhetorical Comprehension, Critique, and Response*.
Stenhouse, 2015, p. 235. © 2015

Activity 30: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Reader Feedback

You will need a partner for this activity. Partner A will read a paragraph or section aloud from their composition (if the text is a poem, Partner A can read a few lines or a stanza). After Partner A reads the paragraph or section, Partner B will explain what they understand and what they don't understand about what was read. Partner A will continue reading their work aloud, stopping after each section to allow Partner B a chance to respond. After Partner A finishes reading, the pair will switch roles.

Be sure to keep your reader feedback focused on the following two kinds of responses:

- What you understand
- What you need help understanding

As you revise your work, consider ways to help your reader more fully understand your message and purpose.

Editing

Activity 31: Editing Your Draft – Sample Student Essay

Read the following student essay on the topic of undocumented immigration (used with permission). Edit the essay using the conventions of academic English. Pay careful attention to sentence boundaries, subject-verb agreement, spelling, and punctuation. Add adjectives and transitions in places where you think they will improve the clarity and cohesion of the essay.

You can make your changes on the essay itself. Use the margins or the bottom of the page if you need more room to revise sentences.

Sample Student Essay:

Does illegal immigrations cause more harm to the United States or to the illegal immigrants. Illegal immigration effects the United States as well as the illegal aliens in many ways. The United States is affected positively and negatively, immigrants face many difficulties and dangers. These challenges are many. Including separation from family, loss of innocence, and in many cases death. The negative effects on the United States include more taxes and create crowded housing. While illegal immigration is harmful to both the United States and the immigrants, the struggles that immigrants face on their journey make it worse for them.

Illegal immigrants struggle through many hardships that encourage their decision to migrate to other countries. These reasons including financial instability, starvation, and separation from family members. Garcia clearly shows many examples in her poems. Garcia shows the problem of financial need when she stated, "... no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here". A main reason for immigrants leaving there home country is that they have nothing left to live for there and will not survive if they do not make a change. This financial problem leads into their issue with starvation. Starvation is presented when her mother's thoughts are expressed; "No water, no beans or corn...She cannot stay with me. I will not have her stay with me to starve" (Line 8, 11). Starvation leads her mother to justify sending away her daughter; "A child should not see a mother

starve to death” (Line 16). While these hardships and struggles cause pain to illegal immigrant, there are many dangers on the journey itself that bring upon harm as well.

Along with problems like starving, they encounter many dangers on their journeys. Diana Garcia’s poems, *On Leaving | On Staying Behind*, also shows these dangers they encounter. For example, in *On Leaving*, Garcia states, “... mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life” (Line 19, 20). This suggests that on immigrant’s journeys, they cannot stand up for themselves, they must give in to anything in order to protect themselves. *On Staying Behind* expresses the mother’s worries when she says, “The journey is harsh, more than two weeks if she’s lucky” (Line 5), and “So many dangers, only two younger male cousins to protect her” (Line 6). Unfortunately these dangers and hardships are only the ones immigrants will face before arriving to a new country, if they survive the journey, new struggles are placed of them once they arrive. Such as deportation fears and to find a job to start there new lives.

It might be believed that immigration is more harmful to the United States due to the crowded housing, taxes, and American jobs. Immigration does effect property values negatively as there are many illegal families renting out rooms rather than apartments and tax rates of United States citizens does inflate to include the education of the children of illegal immigrants. However, the claim that immigrants are “stealing” American jobs is just an opinion, it’s not a proven fact; “One study from the National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) found that immigration leads to labor specialization, which increases total factor productivity” (Jacqueline Varas). This statement shows that immigrant worker do specific jobs that they have the ability and skills necessary to do. This is how illegal immigrants help the United States economy, not hurt it.

Illegal immigration is harmful to both United States and the immigrants. While both are harmed immigrants receive most of the hardships and struggles do to the dangerous journey and difficult family situations. The United States economy benefits from these illegal immigrants. There is an increase in factor productivity as well as in employment opportunities.

Activity 32: Editing Your Draft – Your Own Essay

Now spend several minutes editing your own composition, applying what you learned from editing a sample student essay as a class. Keep in mind that while a profile feature article will typically follow the conventions of standardized English, poetry and creative nonfiction may not. Make choices about grammar, usage, and mechanics that are appropriate to your genre and purpose.

Activity 33: Editing Your Draft – Proofreading

Choose a section of your essay to read in reverse. Scan your eyes from right to left across the page, reading the words backwards. This strategy can sometimes help you detect errors that you miss during a regular reading. Be sure your work has been carefully proofread before you share it with your intended audience.

Activity 35: Reflecting on Your Writing Process

Quickwrite: What have you learned about your ability to take effective rhetorical action in response to issues and needs that you care about? How will you apply this learning in the future?

Activity 36: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals

Finally, revisit the questions you asked yourself at the start of this module:

- What strengths do I have as a reader and writer that I can build on?
- What do I want to learn how to do or do better?
- What do I need to keep me moving forward in my intellectual growth?

What learning goals did you set for yourself? Locate these in your notes. What did you do to imagine and create your success as you engaged the learning experiences in this module?

Reflect on your learning goals in a five-minute quickwrite.